

Role Guide 6: Documentary Evidence Research Assistant

Step-by-step instructions for the Documentary RA role in the ABF-FST Digital Respondent Portal.

STUDY	Developing and Validating the Agribusiness Bankability Framework for Food Systems Transformation through Novel Financing Models in Zimbabwe (ABF-FST)
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FOR	Research assistants who collect, assess and code documentary evidence
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VERSION	Version 1.0 · 15 September 2026

Screenshots in this document use *fictional demonstration data*. Organisation and person names, phone numbers and figures shown in them are not real study records.

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1. Your role at a glance

You build the documentary corpus of 50–75 coded sources: record each document, judge its authenticity before it can be included, explain your reasoning in a memo, and code it with the Document, Digital Platform & Media Analysis Tool in KoboToolbox.

You can

- See the KII/Doc Dashboard, the Documents register and document records.
- Create document records, assess authenticity, include or exclude, write memos.
- Download PDFs of completed document coding forms.

You cannot

- See or edit KII records, questionnaire QA, the Main-400 register, costs or exports.
- Include a document before its authenticity has been assessed.

Where this fits

The System Manual explains how the whole system works. This guide covers only what you do. Ask the Field Coordinator or PI when something is outside your role.

2. Signing in and your screens

Signing in

1. Open <https://research.agribizframework.com/admin/login> in any modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari), on a computer, tablet or phone.
2. Type your **Username** and **Password**, then select **Sign in**.

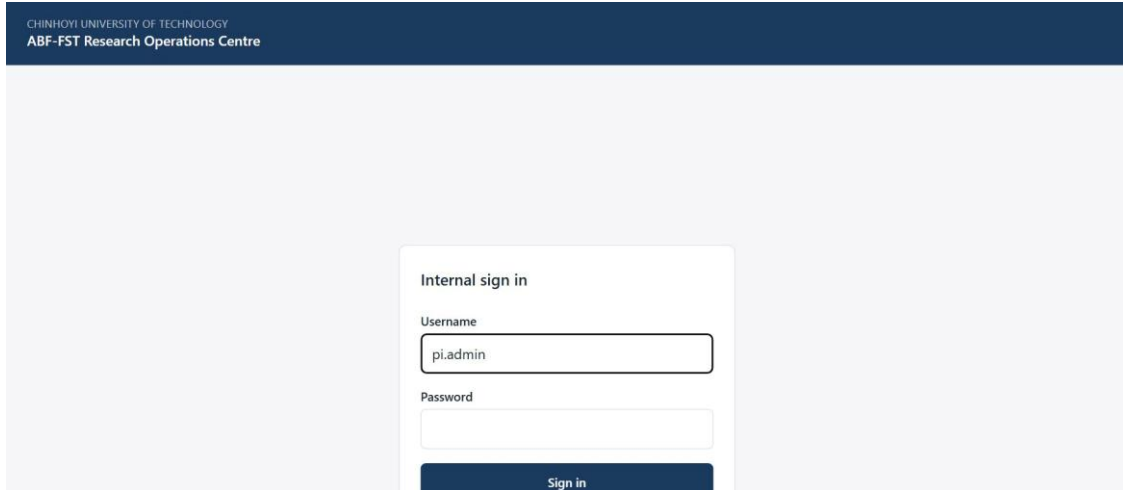
The image shows a web browser window with a dark blue header bar at the top. The header contains the text 'CHINGHOY UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY' and 'ABF-FST Research Operations Centre' in white. Below the header is a light gray background. In the center, there is a white rectangular box containing the 'Internal sign in' form. The form has two input fields: 'Username' with the text 'pi.admin' and 'Password'. Below the password field is a dark blue button with the text 'Sign in' in white.

Figure 1. The sign-in screen for all internal staff.

3. You arrive on your start screen: **KII/Doc Dashboard**. The bar across the top lists only the screens your role (Documentary RA) can open.

Accounts

There is no self-registration. The PI / System Admin creates every account and sets its role. Ask the PI if you need an account, a different role, or a password reset.

Finding your way around

- The **top bar** shows your username and role, and the screens you can use. It is not a full menu with some items greyed out: anything absent is simply not part of your role.
- Most screens have a **← Back to ...** link at the top that returns you to the screen you came from.
- Registers show **20 rows per page**. Use **Previous** and **Next** at the foot of the list, and the **Search** box above it.
- **Change password** (top right) lets you set a new password at any time. Choose a long password you do not use anywhere else.
- **Sign out** (top right) ends your session. Always sign out on a shared or public computer.
- If you are inactive for a while you may be asked to sign in again. This protects research data on unattended devices.

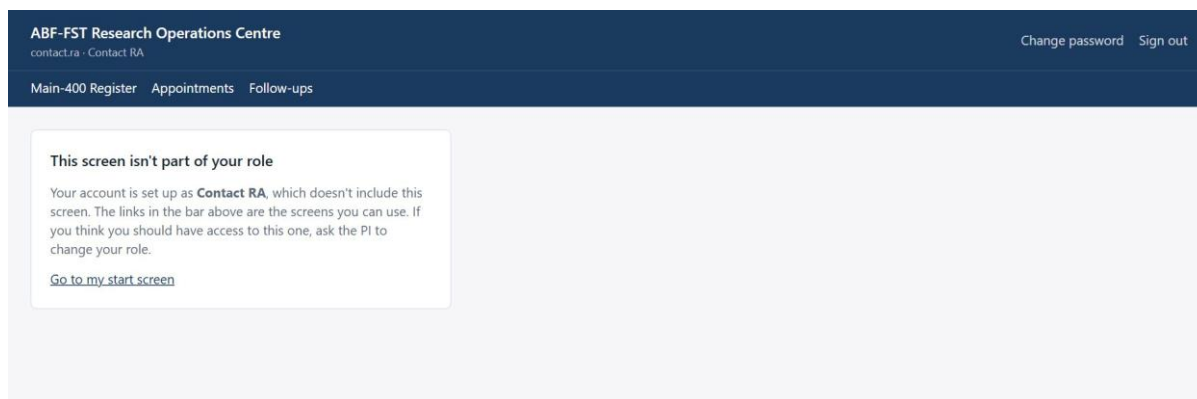


Figure 2. Opening a screen outside your role (for example from an old bookmark) shows this card instead of the screen.

Your screens

Screen	What you use it for
KII/Doc Dashboard	Documents by type and QA status against the 50–75 target.
Form PDFs	Completed document coding forms.
Documents	The corpus; create and manage records.

Changing your password

1. Select **Change password** in the top right corner.
2. Enter your **Current password**, then the **New password** twice, and select **Change password**.

The screenshot shows the 'Change Password' screen. The top navigation bar includes 'Change password' and 'Sign out'. The main content area has a 'Back to Dashboard' link and the title 'Change Password'. Below the title is a form with three input fields: 'Current password', 'New password', and 'Confirm new password'. A 'Change password' button is at the bottom of the form.

Figure 3. Change Password screen.

3. Use the new password next time you sign in. If you have forgotten your password, ask the PI to reset it.

3. Your routine

A suggested rhythm. Adjust it to the Field Coordinator's plan.

When	What to do
When you find a source	Create the record with a precise reference and an evidence extract.
Assessment	Verify authenticity against the source; mark Verified or Disputed; write the memo.
Inclusion	Include or Exclude with reasons in the memo.
Coding	Complete the Document Analysis Tool in KoboToolbox using the DOC ID.

4. Step-by-step tasks

4.1 Reading the dashboard

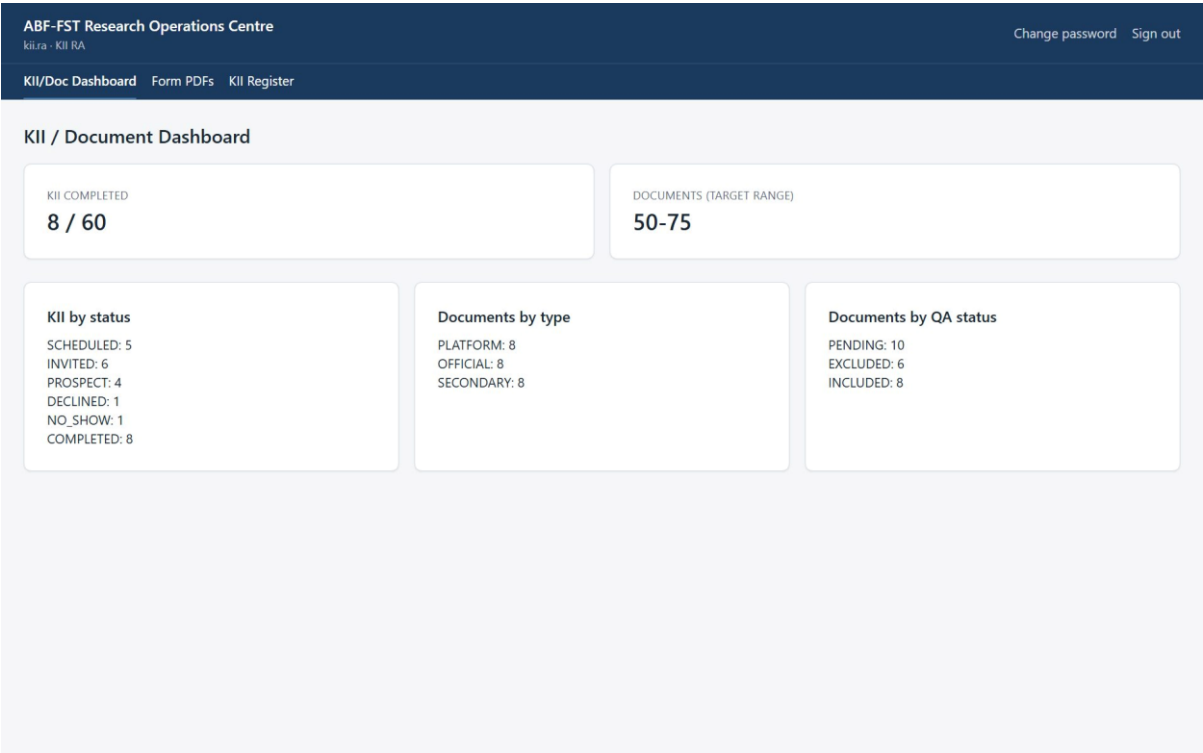


Figure 4. Documents by type and by QA status.

4.2 Adding a document

1. Select Documents → New document.

The screenshot shows the 'New Documentary Evidence Record' form with the following fields:

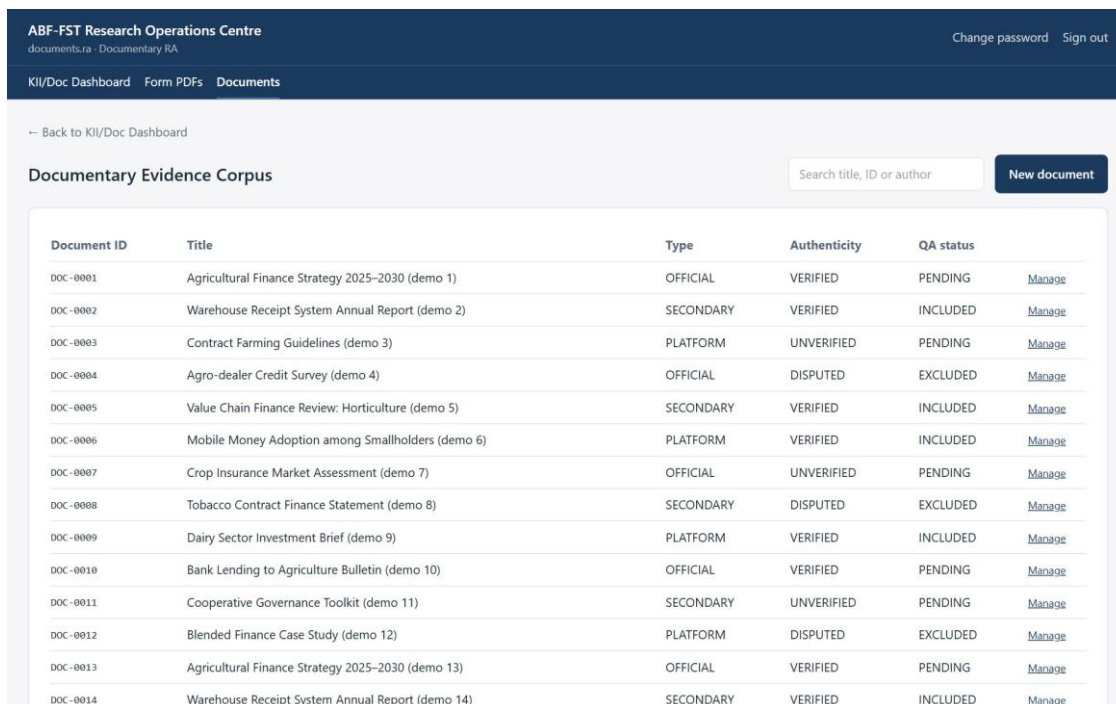
- Title
- Author / speaker
- Source URL / reference
- Document type (dropdown menu, currently set to OFFICIAL)
- Geographic scope
- Evidence extract

Figure 5. New Documentary Evidence Record.

2. Enter **Title**, **Author / speaker**, **Source URL / reference**, **Document type** (OFFICIAL, SECONDARY or PLATFORM), **Geographic scope** and an **Evidence extract**, then select **Create document record**. The document ID (e.g. DOC-0025) is generated.

4.3 Assessing and including a document

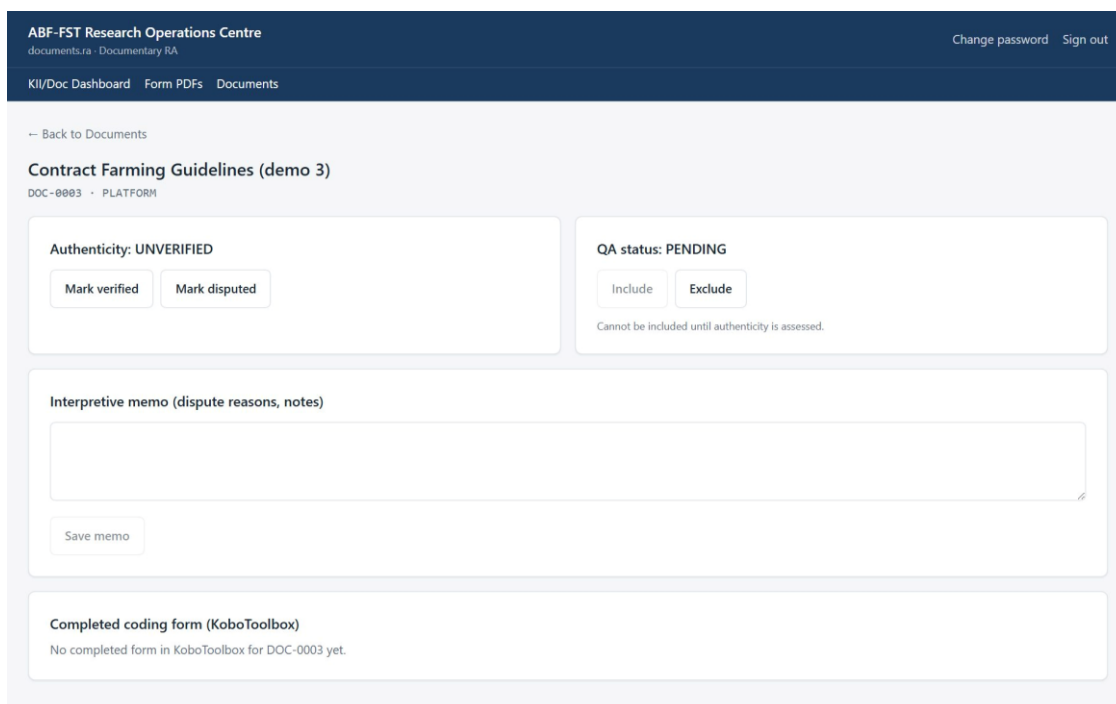
1. In **Documents**, select **Manage** on the record.



Document ID	Title	Type	Authenticity	QA status	
DOC-0001	Agricultural Finance Strategy 2025-2030 (demo 1)	OFFICIAL	VERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0002	Warehouse Receipt System Annual Report (demo 2)	SECONDARY	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0003	Contract Farming Guidelines (demo 3)	PLATFORM	UNVERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0004	Agro-dealer Credit Survey (demo 4)	OFFICIAL	DISPUTED	EXCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0005	Value Chain Finance Review: Horticulture (demo 5)	SECONDARY	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0006	Mobile Money Adoption among Smallholders (demo 6)	PLATFORM	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0007	Crop Insurance Market Assessment (demo 7)	OFFICIAL	UNVERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0008	Tobacco Contract Finance Statement (demo 8)	SECONDARY	DISPUTED	EXCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0009	Dairy Sector Investment Brief (demo 9)	PLATFORM	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0010	Bank Lending to Agriculture Bulletin (demo 10)	OFFICIAL	VERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0011	Cooperative Governance Toolkit (demo 11)	SECONDARY	UNVERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0012	Blended Finance Case Study (demo 12)	PLATFORM	DISPUTED	EXCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0013	Agricultural Finance Strategy 2025-2030 (demo 13)	OFFICIAL	VERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0014	Warehouse Receipt System Annual Report (demo 14)	SECONDARY	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage

Figure 6. Documentary Evidence Corpus.

2. Assess authenticity: select **Mark verified** or **Mark disputed**.



ABF-FST Research Operations Centre
documents.ra · Documentary RA

KII/Doc Dashboard Form PDFs Documents

← Back to Documents

Contract Farming Guidelines (demo 3)
DOC-0003 · PLATFORM

Authenticity: UNVERIFIED

[Mark verified](#) [Mark disputed](#)

QA status: PENDING

[Include](#) [Exclude](#)

Cannot be included until authenticity is assessed.

Interpretive memo (dispute reasons, notes)

[Save memo](#)

Completed coding form (KoboToolbox)

No completed form in KoboToolbox for DOC-0003 yet.

Figure 7. Document record: authenticity, QA status, memo and coding form.

3. Set the QA status: **Include** or **Exclude**. A document cannot be included until authenticity has been assessed.
4. Write the **Interpretive memo** (dispute reasons, interpretation notes) and select **Save memo**.
5. Code the document in the **Document, Digital Platform & Media Analysis Tool** in KoboToolbox using the DOC ID; its PDF then appears on the record.

4.4 Downloading or emailing completed forms (Form PDFs)

1. Select **Form PDFs**. You see the completed Document Analysis Tool forms from KoboToolbox, newest first.
2. Select **Download PDF** to save a readable copy: sections, questions, the chosen answers as words (not codes) and repeated groups.
3. Select **Email to me** to send the PDF to the email address on your account.

The same PDF is available from the record itself: the case page (questionnaire), the KII page (KII Guide) or the document page (coding form).

4.5 Judging authenticity

- **Official**: from a government body, regulator or the organisation itself — check it on the issuer's own site or registry.
- **Secondary**: reports, studies, articles — check the publisher, author and date.
- **Platform**: websites, social media, digital platforms — capture the URL and date accessed; corroborate claims elsewhere.
- Mark **Disputed** when authorship, date or content cannot be confirmed, and say why in the memo.

5. Rules you must follow

- Record the exact source reference so another researcher can find the same document.
- Do not store copyrighted documents outside the study's approved storage.
- Treat everything in the portal as **confidential research data**. Do not screenshot, copy, print or forward names, phone numbers, email addresses or answers except as your role requires.
- Never share your username or password, and never sign in for someone else.
- Use the respondent's contact details **only** to manage their participation in this study (invitations, reminders, appointments).
- Never tell a respondent, lender or anyone else that answers affect financing. The study generates **no score, rating or financing decision**.
- If a respondent asks to withdraw, stop contacting them and tell the Field Coordinator or PI the same day so the withdrawal is recorded.
- Report a lost device, a suspected account compromise, or data sent to the wrong person to the PI immediately.

6. Troubleshooting

Situation	Likely cause	What to do
Include is greyed out	Authenticity not assessed.	Mark verified or disputed first.
No coding form PDF on the record	The form was not submitted with this DOC ID.	Check the DOC ID in the KoboToolbox form.
"This screen isn't part of your role"	The screen belongs to another role (often an old bookmark or shared link).	Select Go to my start screen. If you need that screen, ask the PI about your role.
"Too many sign-in attempts from this network"	Sign-in is rate-limited per network; an office shares one address.	Wait a minute and try again. A wrong password says so explicitly.
A register shows fewer rows than expected	Registers show 20 rows per page; a Contact RA sees only assigned cases.	Use Next, or search. Ask the Field Coordinator to assign the case.
A button is greyed out	A required step is missing (a note, an authenticity decision, a selection).	Read the message beside the button; complete the missing step first.
"KoboToolbox couldn't be reached"	KoboToolbox is slow or the connection token has changed.	Try again in a few minutes. If it persists, tell the PI.
A page keeps loading	A slow or dropped connection.	Refresh the page. Your saved work is not lost; unsaved typing may be.

7. Quick reference

Sign in	https://research.agribizframework.com/admin/login
You start on	KII/Doc Dashboard
Target	50–75 coded documents
Types	OFFICIAL, SECONDARY, PLATFORM
Order	Create → assess authenticity → include/exclude → memo → code
Help	Field Coordinator; PI: Happyson Saina, 0773943709, abffst.research.cut@gmail.com